

# HR POLICY HANDBOOK

## Employee Policies, Workplace Standards & Benefits

**Document Version:** 1.0

**Effective Date:** 1 January 2026

**Applies To:** Full-time, part-time, temporary and eligible contract employees

**Policy Owner:** Human Resources Department

This handbook provides a consolidated set of workplace policies for employees and managers. Employees are expected to read, understand and follow the policies that apply to their role.

**Important:** This is a sample HR policy handbook prepared for HR Policy Assistant testing and demonstration. It should be reviewed and adapted by an organization before being used as an official employment policy.

# **1. Employment & Workplace Standards**

## **1.1 Equal Employment Opportunity**

The organization is committed to fair employment practices. Employment decisions including recruitment, selection, promotion, compensation, training and termination should be based on qualifications, performance, business requirements and applicable law.

## **1.2 Professional Conduct**

Employees must act honestly, respectfully and professionally. Harassment, discrimination, threats, intimidation, violence, retaliation, falsification of records and deliberate misuse of company resources are prohibited.

## **1.3 Employment Categories**

- Full-time employees normally work the organization's standard weekly schedule.
- Part-time employees work an agreed reduced schedule.
- Temporary employees are engaged for a defined period or assignment.
- Contract employees are governed by their applicable contract and company rules.

## **1.4 Probation**

New employees may be subject to a probationary period of six months unless the appointment letter states otherwise. During probation, performance, attendance, conduct and role suitability may be reviewed.

## **1.5 Personnel Records**

Employees must provide accurate personal, contact, banking and emergency information and promptly notify HR when important information changes.

## **2. Working Hours, Attendance & Remote Work**

### **2.1 Standard Working Hours**

Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday through Friday, with a one-hour lunch break. Business teams may operate different schedules when approved by management.

### **2.2 Attendance**

Employees are expected to report to work on time, remain available during working hours and accurately record attendance where an attendance system is provided.

### **2.3 Late Arrival and Early Departure**

Employees who expect to be late or need to leave early should inform their manager as soon as reasonably possible. Repeated unexplained lateness may be treated as an attendance issue.

### **2.4 Work From Home**

Eligible employees may work remotely when the role permits and the arrangement has been approved. Employees working remotely must maintain working-hour availability, protect company information and attend required meetings.

### **2.5 Overtime**

Work beyond the normal schedule should be approved in advance by the manager. Overtime compensation or time-off arrangements will follow the employee's applicable terms and company rules.

### **2.6 Attendance During Emergencies**

Employees should follow HR or management instructions during severe weather, infrastructure disruptions, public emergencies or other events affecting normal operations.

## **3. Leave & Time-Off Policy**

### **3.1 Casual Leave**

Employees are eligible for 12 days of casual leave per calendar year. Casual leave is intended for short personal needs and should normally be requested in advance where practicable.

### **3.2 Sick Leave**

Employees are eligible for 12 days of sick leave per calendar year. If illness prevents attendance, the employee should notify the manager as soon as possible. A medical certificate may be requested for extended or repeated absence.

### **3.3 Earned / Annual Leave**

Employees are eligible for 18 days of earned leave per calendar year after completing the applicable eligibility requirements. Leave should be planned in advance and approved by the reporting manager.

### **3.4 Leave Approval**

Leave requests should be submitted through the designated HR or attendance system. Approval depends on staffing requirements, business continuity and the employee's available balance.

### **3.5 Public Holidays**

Employees receive applicable public holidays announced for the organization and location. Holiday calendars may differ by office or statutory requirements.

### **3.6 Unpaid Leave**

Unpaid leave may be approved in exceptional circumstances when paid leave is unavailable or insufficient. Approval is discretionary and should be obtained before the absence whenever possible.

### **3.7 Leave Carry Forward**

Unused earned leave may be carried forward up to 15 days into the next calendar year unless a local rule or appointment condition provides otherwise. Casual and sick leave generally do not carry forward.

## **4. Compensation, Payroll & Benefits**

### **4.1 Salary**

Salary is paid monthly through the employee's registered bank account. Employees should keep banking information current with HR.

### **4.2 Payroll Cut-Off**

Changes affecting payroll, such as bank details, approved deductions or eligible allowances, should be submitted before the monthly payroll cut-off communicated by HR.

### **4.3 Deductions**

Statutory deductions and authorized deductions may be made from salary. Employees can contact HR for clarification of payroll items.

### **4.4 Performance Review**

Performance is normally reviewed at least annually. Reviews may consider goals, quality of work, collaboration, attendance, conduct, skills and role responsibilities.

### **4.5 Salary Review**

Salary increases are not automatic. Compensation decisions may consider performance, market conditions, role scope, internal equity and organizational budgets.

### **4.6 Benefits**

Eligible employees may receive benefits such as health insurance, statutory benefits, learning support or other programs according to the applicable plan and employment terms.

### **4.7 Expense Reimbursement**

Reasonable business expenses may be reimbursed when supported by receipts and approved according to the expense policy.

## **5. Code of Conduct, Anti-Harassment & Ethics**

### **5.1 Respectful Workplace**

Every employee has the right to a workplace free from bullying, harassment and discrimination. Employees should communicate respectfully and avoid conduct that creates an intimidating or hostile environment.

### **5.2 Sexual Harassment**

Unwelcome sexual comments, advances, requests, messages, gestures or conduct are prohibited. Complaints will be handled through the designated grievance or committee process.

### **5.3 Discrimination**

Discrimination based on protected characteristics under applicable law is prohibited in employment decisions and workplace interactions.

### **5.4 Conflicts of Interest**

Employees must disclose situations in which personal, financial or family interests could improperly influence business decisions.

### **5.5 Gifts and Hospitality**

Employees must not accept gifts, payments or hospitality that could influence, or reasonably appear to influence, a business decision. Modest customary items may be accepted when permitted by company rules.

### **5.6 Confidentiality**

Employees must protect confidential business information, customer information, employee information, source code, pricing, strategy and other non-public information during and after employment.

### **5.7 Reporting Concerns**

Employees are encouraged to report suspected misconduct, policy violations or unethical behavior to HR, management or the designated reporting channel.

## **6. Information Security, Privacy & Technology**

### **6.1 Password Security**

Employees must use strong passwords, protect authentication credentials and never share passwords. Multi-factor authentication should be used where provided.

### **6.2 Company Devices**

Company laptops, phones and other devices are provided for authorized business purposes. Employees must protect devices from theft, unauthorized access and malware.

### **6.3 Email and Internet**

Company communication systems must be used responsibly. Employees must not send malicious, unlawful, discriminatory or confidential material to unauthorized recipients.

### **6.4 Data Protection**

Personal and confidential information should only be accessed when required for the employee's role. Information must not be copied to unauthorized storage or personal accounts.

### **6.5 Security Incidents**

Lost devices, suspected phishing, accidental disclosure, malware, unauthorized access or other security incidents must be reported to IT or the security team promptly.

### **6.6 Privacy**

Employee personal information is handled for legitimate employment, payroll, benefits, compliance and operational purposes and should be accessed only by authorized personnel.

### **6.7 Acceptable Use of AI**

Employees must not submit confidential, personal or restricted company information to public AI tools unless the tool and use have been approved. AI-generated work must be reviewed for accuracy and compliance.

## **7. Health, Safety & Workplace Facilities**

### **7.1 Safety Responsibility**

Employees must follow workplace safety instructions, report hazards and cooperate with safety procedures. Managers are responsible for addressing known risks.

### **7.2 Emergency Procedures**

Employees should know emergency exits, assembly points and local emergency contacts. During an emergency, follow instructions from building security, emergency responders and company representatives.

### **7.3 Workplace Violence**

Threats, physical violence, possession of prohibited weapons at the workplace and intentional intimidation are not permitted, subject to applicable law and site rules.

### **7.4 Ergonomics**

Employees should maintain a safe workstation setup and take appropriate breaks from prolonged screen use. Concerns about workstation safety should be raised with the manager or facilities team.

### **7.5 Substance Misuse**

Employees must not report to work impaired by alcohol or illegal drugs. Alcohol or controlled substances may not be used in violation of applicable law or workplace rules.

### **7.6 Clean Workplace**

Employees should maintain clean shared spaces, follow building rules and promptly report maintenance or sanitation concerns.



## **8. Performance, Learning & Career Development**

### **8.1 Goal Setting**

Managers and employees should establish clear role goals and priorities. Goals should be measurable where practical and aligned with team and business objectives.

### **8.2 Performance Improvement**

When performance does not meet expectations, the manager may provide coaching, documented feedback, additional support and a reasonable improvement period.

### **8.3 Training**

Employees may be required to complete compliance, security, safety, role-specific or other mandatory training. Employees are expected to complete assigned training by the communicated deadline.

### **8.4 Learning Support**

The organization may support approved courses, certifications, workshops or conferences where they are relevant to the employee's role and subject to budget approval.

### **8.5 Internal Opportunities**

Employees may apply for internal roles when eligible. Selection depends on qualifications, performance, business requirements and the applicable recruitment process.

### **8.6 Manager Responsibilities**

Managers should provide regular feedback, support employee development, address performance concerns fairly and avoid favoritism or retaliation.

## **9. Grievance, Discipline & Separation**

### **9.1 Grievance Procedure**

Employees who have a workplace concern should first use the designated reporting or HR channel. Complaints should include relevant facts, dates and supporting information where available.

### **9.2 Non-Retaliation**

Retaliation against an employee who raises a good-faith concern, participates in an investigation or exercises a protected right is prohibited.

### **9.3 Investigation**

HR or an authorized function may review complaints, interview relevant individuals and examine records. Employees are expected to cooperate honestly while maintaining confidentiality.

### **9.4 Disciplinary Action**

Depending on the circumstances, disciplinary action may include coaching, verbal or written warning, final warning, suspension where permitted, or termination. Serious misconduct may result in stronger action.

### **9.5 Resignation**

Employees who resign should provide the notice period stated in their appointment letter or applicable terms. HR will coordinate the exit process.

### **9.6 Final Settlement**

Final salary, eligible leave settlement, approved expenses and other dues will be processed according to company procedures and applicable law after completion of required clearances.

### **9.7 Exit & Company Property**

Employees must return company devices, access cards, documents, keys, confidential materials and other property before or at separation as instructed.

## 10. General Policy Administration & Employee Acknowledgement

### 10.1 Policy Ownership

Human Resources owns and administers this handbook. HR may issue procedures, forms, guidelines or clarifications to support implementation.

### 10.2 Policy Changes

Policies may be updated to reflect business requirements, operational changes or applicable legal requirements. The latest approved version communicated by HR will apply.

### 10.3 Exceptions

Any exception to a policy requires appropriate management and HR approval and may be subject to legal or operational constraints.

### 10.4 Questions

Employees should contact HR or their reporting manager when they need clarification about a policy, leave entitlement, payroll matter, workplace concern or employment process.

### 10.5 Employee Acknowledgement

By acknowledging this handbook, the employee confirms that they have had an opportunity to read and understand the policies and agree to comply with applicable company rules.

### 10.6 Quick Reference

- Standard working hours: 9:30 AM–6:30 PM, Monday–Friday.
- Casual leave: 12 days per calendar year.
- Sick leave: 12 days per calendar year.
- Earned leave: 18 days per calendar year, subject to eligibility.
- Leave carry forward: up to 15 earned-leave days, subject to applicable rules.
- Remote work: permitted when the role and manager-approved arrangement allow it.
- Performance review: normally annual.
- Security incidents: report promptly to IT/security.
- Workplace concerns: report to HR, management or the designated channel.

### Acknowledgement

Employee Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Employee ID: \_\_\_\_\_  
Signature: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_